ARENA SCHOOL

ACAMIS TECHNOLOGY CONFERENCE · OCTOBER 18, 2026

A case study from the International School of Beijing

From Lab *to Classroom*

Running an AI Student Program Inside a School

THE NEXT 60 MINUTES

From what students built in five days *to what you can run at your school.*

1

The case

15 minutes

2

Why it worked

10 minutes

3

Build one, live

30 minutes

4

Take it back

5 minutes

We trained at ISB, Caltech, Harvard, Brown, and Tsinghua, then did *the jobs AI is now automating.*



Jing Jing Yang

WAB AND ISB ALUM · ISB CLASS OF 2019

Ran the AI Founders Program at ISB, summer 2026
Worked in international growth at Kimi, a leading Chinese AI lab

STUDIED INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF BEIJING 北京顺义国际学校 · BROWN · 清華大學 Tsinghua University

WORKED Apple · Deloitte. · CICC 中金公司 · KIMI



Phillip An

FORBES 30 UNDER 30

Co-founder and CEO of Skylarq AI
Co-founder and ex-COO of Homebase, backed by Y Combinator

STUDIED Caltech · HARVARD · 清華大學 Tsinghua University

WORKED Goldman Sachs · McKinsey&Company · LinkedIn

THE QUESTION BEHIND THIS SESSION

When AI can do all of these in seconds, what must our students *still learn to do?*

PART 1

In five days, students built and launched *working products with AI.*

Why it matters, the honest worry, and two real programs

1 The case
What students built

2 Why it worked
The design

3 Build one, live
With the room

4 Take it back
What it takes

ANTHROPIC ECONOMIC INDEX · BASED ON REAL USE OF CLAUDE

In about half of all jobs, AI is already used for *at least a quarter of the tasks.*

ANTHROP\C

Occupations where AI is used in at least a quarter of tasks



Anthropic Economic Index, Jan 15, 2026: share of occupations using AI for at least 25% of their tasks (36% in the January 2025 report). The 2026 figure pools data across reports and reflects how people use Claude, not a census of every worker.

YOUNG WORKERS FEEL IT FIRST · STANFORD, US PAYROLL DATA

In the most exposed jobs, young people are already *19% behind.*

AGES 22 TO 25

−19%

employment in AI-exposed jobs, against peers their age in less-exposed jobs

EXPERIENCED WORKERS

No gap

in the same AI-exposed jobs

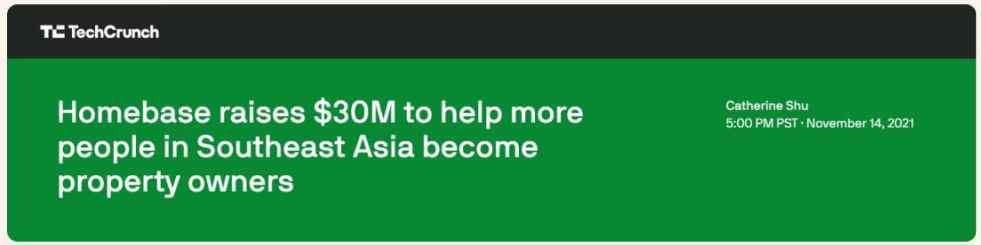
Brynjolfsson, Chandar, and Chen, “Canaries in the Coal Mine?”, revised August 2026; descriptive, not a causal estimate

CASE STUDY · PHILLIP'S COMPANIES

My last company had about 120 people.
My AI-native company has fewer than five.

BEFORE · CO-FOUNDER AND COO

homebase



About 120 people across sales, marketing, product, design, and operations

BACKED BY Y Combinator · Goodwater · partech

→

NOW · CO-FOUNDER AND CEO

Skylarq

Product · Design · Marketing · Social media · Sales

Once separate hires, now two or three of us using AI.

<5 people on the whole team

Building AI agents that run sales and go-to-market.

If I hire again, I'll only hire people who are AI-native and highly leveraged with AI.

THE WORRY · TWO 2025 STUDIES

The worry is fair: when AI does the thinking, *students learn less.*

83%

MIT MEDIA LAB · ESSAY WRITING

of ChatGPT users couldn't quote a sentence from the essay they had just written, against 11% without it

−17%

HIGH SCHOOL MATH · A FIELD EXPERIMENT

exam grades once unrestricted ChatGPT was taken away, against students who never had it

Kosmyna and others, MIT Media Lab, "Your Brain on ChatGPT", June 2025: 54 adults writing essays, a preprint not yet peer-reviewed; Bastani and others, PNAS, June 25, 2025: nearly 1,000 high school math students

THE DIFFERENCE · HOW THE AI IS SET UP

Design is the difference: AI that coaches instead of answering *helps students learn more.*

No drop

SAME MATH STUDY · AN AI TUTOR

in exam grades when the AI was set up to give hints, not answers

2×

HARVARD PHYSICS · A RANDOMIZED TRIAL

the learning gains of an active-learning class, in less time, with an AI tutor built on the same methods

Bastani and others, PNAS, 2025: with safeguards, the harm was “largely mitigated”; Kestin and others, Scientific Reports, June 3, 2025: 194 Harvard physics students, median learning gains more than double

Five days, from a real problem *to a working product on demo day.*

GRADES 7 TO 12 · NO CODING EXPERIENCE NEEDED

DAY 1

Choose a problem

Students pitch problems, and teams form.

DAY 2

Talk to users

Interview the people they want to help, then build.

DAY 3

Live at a link

A working version anyone can open.

DAY 4

Brand and price

Name it, price it, and stop building on time.

DAY 5

Demo day

Judges test each product. Families are in the room.

On day five, teams pitched working products *to judges from Harvard, Stanford, Y Combinator, and AI labs.*



Judges test each product before scoring

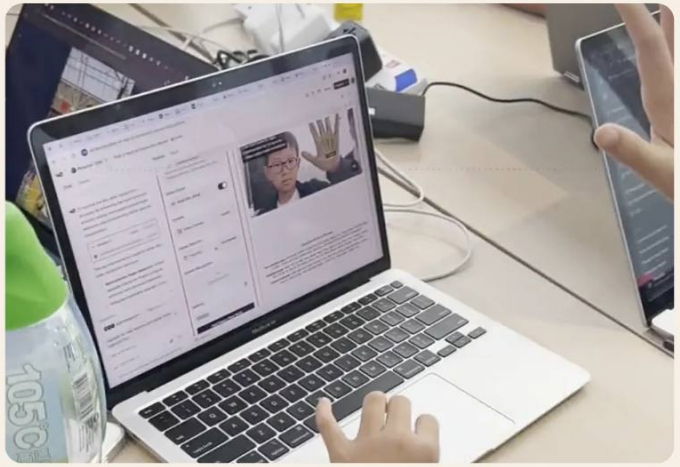


Every team pitched its own product

JUDGED BY FOUNDERS AND OPERATORS FROM HARVARD Stanford Y Combinator *and AI labs*

THE CASE · BODLEY ACADEMY, HONG KONG, SUMMER 2025

In five days, an 11-year-old *turned sign language into speech.*



Built in five days by a seventh grader

01 **Agency**	FIND A PROBLEM	He chose sign language to speech because his cousin is deaf. Nobody assigned it.
02 **Taste**	REAL-USER FEEDBACK	He kept improving it after the demo, because his grandmother couldn't use the first version yet.
03 **Craft**	FINISH AND LAUNCH	The hardest part wasn't the AI. It was audio clear enough for her to trust.

AI tools did the building. *He did the choosing, judging, and finishing.*

20 students, each on their own problem

5 days, from the first idea to demo day

9.5/10 how likely students were to recommend it

PART 2

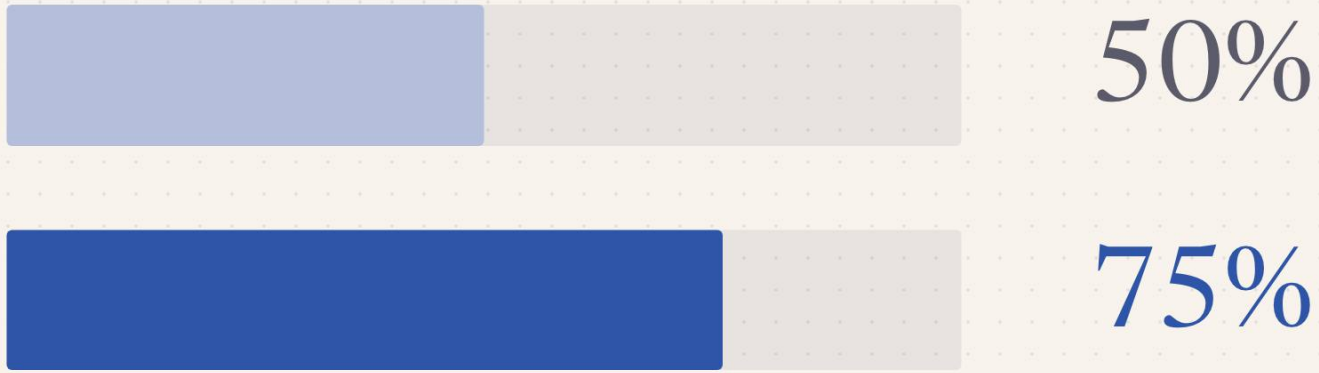
It worked because the week was built around *skills AI can't hand over.*

Students did the thinking. AI did the building.

AI is making the how cheap: *most new code at Google is now drafted by AI.*

Google

Share of new code at Google drafted by AI, then approved by engineers



Sundar Pichai, Google Cloud Next and the company blog, April 22, 2026: 75% of new code, up from 50% last fall

WORLD ECONOMIC FORUM · FUTURE OF JOBS 2025 · 1,000+ EMPLOYERS

So value moves to what to do, *and whether it's good.*

HOW TO DO IT

Write the code

Draft the memo

Run the analysis

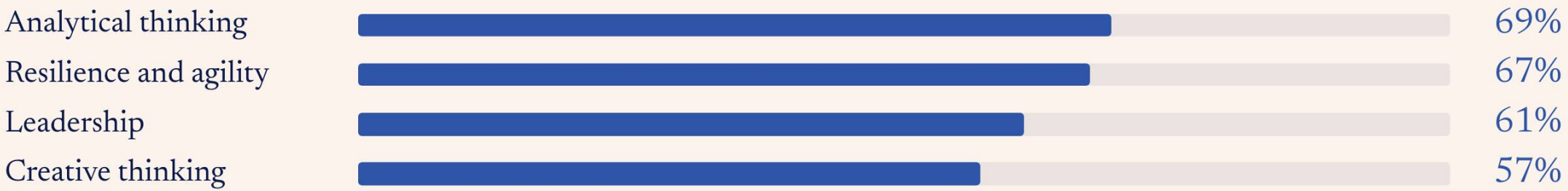
WHAT · WHETHER IT'S GOOD

Decide what to build

Judge the output

Lead people and AI

ESSENTIAL NOW · RISING THROUGH 2030



WEF Future of Jobs 2025, Jan 7, 2025, Fig. 3.3 essential now; Fig. 3.4 rising through 2030. Microsoft 2026 Work Trend Index; LinkedIn Skills on the Rise 2026

NAME THE SCARCE SKILLS

Agency chooses, taste judges, *and craft finishes.*

THE THREE SKILLS

01

Agency

Decide what is worth building before anyone assigns it.

02

Taste

Judge whether the output is actually good.

03

Craft

Finish it so people can trust it.

HOW THE WEEK WAS DESIGNED

Each day of the week *trains one of the three skills.*

SKILL · WHEN · HOW

01

Agency

Day 1. Students choose the problem. Nobody assigns it.

02

Taste

Days 2 and 4. Real users and a real price test whether it's good.

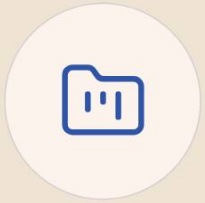
03

Craft

Days 3 and 5. A live link and demo day mean finishing it for real.

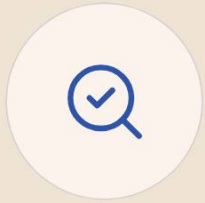
WHAT STUDENTS NEED FROM US

Skills grow from practice with structure, *so your role becomes the coach.*



A real project

with something at stake



A coach

who asks how you checked it



Honest feedback

from real people

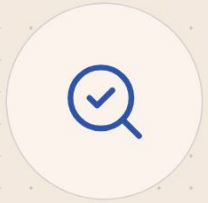
TRY THIS ON MONDAY · THREE COACHING QUESTIONS

Three questions turn any AI task into practice *in agency, taste, and craft.*



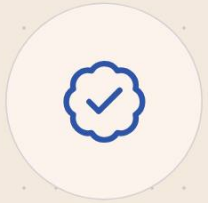
“Why this problem?”

Agency: they choose, not the AI



“How do you know it’s good?”

Taste: they judge what it made



“What would make someone trust it?”

Craft: they check and finish it

PART 3

Now we build one together. *No coding needed.*

You choose the class. We build a practice game for it, live.

1 The case
What students built

2 Why it worked
The design

3 Build one, live
With the room

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What it takes

LIVE BUILD · 30 MINUTES

You pick a class and a topic.
We build a practice game for it, live.

STEP 1 · YOU DESCRIBE IT

In plain English

Call out the class, the topic, and what the game should do.

→

STEP 2 · AI BUILDS IT

A first version in minutes

We say what you asked for to an AI tool that writes the code.

→

STEP 3 · WE ALL CHECK IT

Is it right? Is it good?

Wrong answers, unclear wording, and tiny buttons get fixed.

> *The same loop your students would run: choose, judge, and finish.*

LIVE BUILD · OPEN IT ON YOUR PHONE

It's live. *Open it on your phone.*

PLAY THE GAME

arenaschool.org/talks/2026-10-acamis-tech-workshop/build

WHAT IT TOOK

One room, 30 minutes, and plain English.

No code typed by hand. Every choice was yours: the topic, the questions, and what counted as good enough.

PART 4

Take it back to your school: *what it takes to run this.*

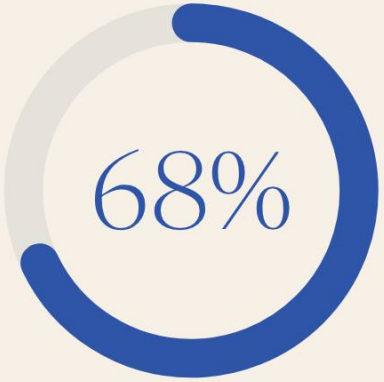
TEACHERS AND AI · GALLUP AND THE WALTON FAMILY FOUNDATION, 2025

Teachers who use AI weekly save almost six hours a week, *yet 68% have had no training.*

5.9
hours

WEEKLY AI USERS

saved each week, about six weeks over a school year



of teachers have had no training on AI from their school or district

Gallup and Walton Family Foundation, survey of 2,232 US public K–12 teachers, March–April 2025, published June 2025. Teachers who use AI less often reported smaller savings.

TAKE IT BACK · PLANNING CHECKLIST

Your school already owns most of this. *A practitioner covers the rest.*

YOUR SCHOOL OWNS

- The learning goals and lasting skills
- A five-day block on the calendar
- Teachers, IT, and families on board
- How students show their work

WHERE A PRACTITIONER HELPS

- Matching AI tools to each task
- Prompting that builds thinking
- Working around blocked tools
- Taking an idea to a product in days

The full checklist and a guide to AI tools on school networks in China are on the session page: arenaschool.org/talks/2026-10-acamis-tech-workshop

THIS HOUR WAS THE DEMO

Going further: we help schools bring AI *into teaching and learning.*

AI for Educators

Hands-on training at your school, with your teachers' own lessons

Student programs

A five-day build week like ISB's, run with your teachers

Curriculum design

Where AI fits in your courses, and how to assess it

SELECTED WORK

INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF BEIJING 北京顺义国际学校

Bodley Academy, Hong Kong

SCHWARZMAN SCHOLARS

IF YOU REMEMBER ONE THING

AI doesn't have to do the thinking for students.

The design is up to us.

1

The worry is fair

Used as a shortcut,
AI skips the thinking.

2

Design decides

Students choose, judge,
and finish. AI builds.

3

Start small, start now

One project, one class,
and three questions.

You don't need to code. You already know how to coach.

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Thank you! *We welcome your questions.*

SLIDES AND RESOURCES

arenaschool.org/talks/2026-10-acamis-tech-workshop

BRING THIS TO YOUR SCHOOL

jingjing@arenaschool.org

Book a 20-minute call about teacher training, student programs, or curriculum design.